

Saul D. Bid

Your grievance with Grant

Grant threatened to expose a private sale you arranged outside your auction house's normal process unless you waived a substantial fee.

Your other secret

You did route the sale through a discreet subsidiary to satisfy a client who insisted on anonymity.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
3. Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Round 1 / Motive

When questioned, read your answer. It is the same whether you are innocent or the murderer.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

I arranged a private sale outside my auction house's normal process. Grant threatened to expose it unless I waived a substantial fee. He wanted the convenience of discretion and the price of a favor. My career was his bargaining chip.

Your next action

Ask the next seated guest their named Motive question in the question catalog. Note one grievance that might matter. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 2 / Opportunity

When questioned, read the answer for your role. Keep the section labels to yourself.

IF INNOCENT

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, discussing the auction fee. I visited the conservation display, checking a sale display sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key.

IF MURDERER

I went into the Donor Salon at 6:45, discussing the auction fee. I visited the conservation display, checking a sale display sample, but did not borrow the cabinet key.

After answering, ask the next seated guest their named Opportunity question in the catalog. Wait for the host before turning the page.

Round 3 / Method

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: IF INNOCENT = Card B; IF MURDERER = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

When questioned, read your answer below, then your selected receipt. Leave the unused card hidden.

IF INNOCENT

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for polishing a catalogue stand. That was what the materials desk issued me.

IF MURDERER

I carried a white linen cloth with a gold seam, for polishing a catalogue stand. That was what the materials desk issued me.

Put the read receipt on the Evidence Table. Discuss, then vote privately. The host will distribute FINALE envelopes only after collecting all ballots.